

There's a wideness in God's mercy

Text: Frederick W. Faber, 1861

Music: Lizzie S. Tourjee, 1878

WELLESLEY 87.87

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef and a bass line in bass clef. The key signature has three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat) and the time signature is 2/2. The melody is composed of eighth and quarter notes, often beamed together. The bass line consists of sustained chords, primarily triads and dyads. Chord symbols are placed above the staff: A-flat, E-flat7, A-flat, D-flat, A-flat, E-flat, A-flat, B-flat, E-flat in the first system; and E-flat7, A-flat, E-flat7, A-flat, F minor, D-flat minor, A-flat, D-flat, E-flat7, A-flat in the second system. The lyrics are printed below the staff, with five lines of text corresponding to the five measures of the first system and five lines for the second system.

1 There's a wide-ness in God's mer - cy like the wide - ness of the sea.
2 There is wel - come for the sin - ner, and more grac - es for the good.
3 But we make God's love too nar - row by false lim - its of our own,
4 For the love of God is broad - er than the mea - sures of the mind,
5 If our love were but more sim - ple, we should rest up - on God's word,

1 There's a kind - ness in God's jus - tice, which is more than lib - er - ty.
2 There is mer - cy with the Sav - ior, there is heal - ing in his blood.
3 and we mag - ni - fy its strict - ness with a zeal God will not own.
4 and the heart of the E - ter - nal is most won - der - ful - ly kind.
5 and our lives would be il - lu - mined by the pres - ence of our Lord.